# Academic Policy Handbook 2026

## 1 Purpose and Scope

This handbook sets out the academic rules that apply to every full-time diploma student at Northbridge Polytechnic for Academic Year 2026. Where a module guide gives a stricter rule, the module guide applies to that module only.

Students are expected to read this handbook at the start of each semester. Not knowing a rule is not accepted as a reason for breaking it.

## 2 Attendance Requirements

Students must attend at least 85 percent of the scheduled lessons in each module, including lectures, tutorials and practical sessions. Attendance is taken in the first 15 minutes of every lesson through the NorthbridgeOne app.

A student who arrives more than 15 minutes after the lesson starts is marked late. Three late arrivals in the same module count as one absence.

A student whose attendance falls below 85 percent in a module is barred from the final assessment of that module and receives a grade of F (Fail, debarred). Absences covered by a valid medical certificate or an approved leave of absence are excluded from the calculation.

## 2.1 Leave of Absence

Students who expect to miss lessons for official representation, compassionate reasons or national service obligations must apply for a leave of absence through the Student Portal at least five working days in advance. Compassionate leave for the death of an immediate family member may be applied for within three working days after the event.

## 3 Assessment and Grading

Each module is assessed through a combination of coursework and a final examination or final project. The weighting of each component is stated in the module guide published in Week 1.

Grades are awarded as follows:

- A: 80 marks and above (grade point 4.0)
- B+: 75 to 79 marks (grade point 3.5)
- B: 70 to 74 marks (grade point 3.0)
- C+: 65 to 69 marks (grade point 2.5)
- C: 60 to 64 marks (grade point 2.0)
- D+: 55 to 59 marks (grade point 1.5)
- D: 50 to 54 marks (grade point 1.0)
- F: below 50 marks (grade point 0.0)

The Grade Point Average (GPA) is the credit-weighted average of grade points for all modules taken in a semester. The Cumulative GPA (CGPA) covers every module taken since the start of the diploma.

### 3.1 Late Submission of Coursework

Coursework submitted after the deadline without an approved extension is penalised by 10 percent of the marks obtained for each calendar day it is late, up to a maximum of three days. Work submitted more than three days late receives zero marks.

An extension of up to five working days may be granted by the module coordinator if the request is made before the deadline and is supported by evidence, such as a medical certificate. Requests made after the deadline are only considered in exceptional circumstances.

### 3.2 Academic Probation

A student whose semester GPA falls below 1.5 is placed on academic probation for the following semester and must meet an academic advisor at least twice during that semester. A student who is placed on probation for two consecutive semesters may be withdrawn from the diploma.

## 4 Academic Integrity

All submitted work must be the student's own. Plagiarism, collusion, contract cheating and the fabrication of data are serious academic offences.

Students may use generative AI tools only where the module guide explicitly allows it, and must declare how the tool was used in an appendix to the submission. Undeclared use of generative AI is treated as plagiarism.

Penalties depend on the severity of the offence and whether it is a first offence:

- First minor offence: a written warning and the work is re-marked with the copied portions excluded.
- First major offence: zero marks for the assessment component.
- Repeat offence: zero marks for the module and referral to the Disciplinary Committee, which may suspend or expel the student.

## 5 Appeals

A student may appeal against a final module grade within five working days after results are released. Appeals are submitted through the Student Portal and cost an administrative fee of 20 dollars per module, which is refunded if the appeal results in a grade change.

An appeal is a review of whether marks were totalled and recorded correctly and whether the assessment followed the published rules. It is not a re-mark of the student's answers against a different standard. The outcome is released within 15 working days.